

THE WIN-WIN TRADE DEAL IN

KEY TAKEAWAYS

- The US-India trade deal was a year in the making and was driven by the personal rapport between President Trump and PM Modi
- Three 'breakthroughs'—in trade, technology cooperation and strategic coordination—underscore US-India ties
- US partnership with India is central to supply chains of critical minerals and semiconductors, as well as in AI and the new Pax Silica
- In security and defence ties, there has been a shift from traditional sales to co-production and joint innovation
- India has now been recognised by Washington as a key pillar in America's Indo-Pacific strategy

his first public appearance as the US ambassador to India at the India Today conclave 2026, Sergio Gor highlighted strong India-US ties driven by perfect political alignment, emphasising the personal friendship between Prime Minister Narendra Modi and President Donald Trump. Gor marked three "breakthroughs" as the cornerstone of India-US ties—in trade, technological cooperation and strategic coordination.

The US ambassador described the newly concluded trade agreement as a "win-win" outcome built on reciprocity. He also indicated that the two countries were close to signing a critical minerals agreement. "Reliable and diversified supply chains for critical minerals are indispensable to economic growth and national security," he said. A key focus was the US Pax Silica initiative—a strategic effort to secure the silicon ecosystem, from raw materials to AI infrastructure—with India among the first trusted partners. Gor said India hosting the Global AI summit "spoke volumes" and encouraged India to adopt advanced American tech stacks while maintaining data sovereignty. He also noted India's central position in the Indo-Pacific, its key role in the Quad, and the US intent to revitalise it. He discussed possible energy cooperation in civil nuclear energy, LNG, coal and new technology like carbon capture. On defence ties, he indicated the shift from traditional trade to co-production, joint R&D and expanded engagement across domains, including cyber and space.

Gor described the Iran conflict as necessary to deny Tehran a covert nuclear bomb, saying it would bring stability to the world. He defended the shifting US positions on Russian oil—the earlier ban and its current relaxation—arguing they reflect changing geopolitical realities.

A significant strategic signal came from his dual role as special envoy to South and Central Asia, now based in New Delhi—a shift that places India at the centre of regional diplomacy. Gor also acknowledged delays in H-1B and H-4 visas for Indians, but linked them to "tighter US border security". ■